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Address Types and Formats

Updated 9 months ago

Overview

All blockchain networks require a wallet with an address to receive funds. Some blockchain networks support wallets containing multiple addresses, while other networks only support single-address wallets.

Address types use cases

Deposit addresses are used in a variety of cases, such as:

- Sharing addresses with counterparties to receive incoming transactions.
- Connecting the addresses to end clients as part of your crypto retail or banking platform.
- Migrating your funds to Fireblocks from your previous custody solution.
- Whitelisting addresses on connected exchanges or other third-party accounts to withdraw to Fireblocks.

On Fireblocks, an asset wallet's permanent address is the first deposit address generated when the wallet is created. For UTXO-based assets, you can generate additional deposit addresses if needed, but account-based assets have only one permanent address.

All addresses are [mathematically derived from one base root address](#) for your workspace. You can use [a Fireblocks open-source tool](#) to generate all of your addresses from that base root address. You can choose to provide other parties with only one address from the asset's derivation path, so the rest of your contacts are not exposed to your other addresses.

Please note that you are unable to import third-party wallet addresses into Fireblocks due to security reasons.

Account-based assets

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...the same permanent address. You can also use the same deposit address for incoming related usage metrics pertaining to such wallets, see the [How we calculate usage](#) article.

For non-EVM account-based blockchains, asset wallets on the same blockchain in a vault account are assigned the same deposit address. For example, a SOL asset wallet and a USDC asset wallet on Solana will use the same deposit address.

Address formats on EVM Networks

You can enter addresses on Ethereum and other EVM-based networks in two ways:

- Non-checksummed, with either all lowercase letters
- Checksummed, which includes upper case letters as well.

Checksummed addresses are more secure, as they can be validated with a typo-proof cryptographic function. If you get the error message “Address does not match selected asset type” or “Invalid address”, it may be due to a bad checksum.

Ensure you use the correct checksummed version of addresses. Most addresses in the Fireblocks Console automatically use the checksummed version. You can copy the address directly from your Console. If you're using the Fireblocks API or need to manually convert an address to a checksummed version, you can search for the address on [Etherscan](#) and copy the address from the top of the page. You can also replace any upper-case letters with corresponding lower-case letters manually.

Multiple addresses (Non-UTXO)

For some assets, you can use the same permanent address for any incoming transaction and use a tag, memo, or note to distinguish between each counterparty. [Learn more about using destination tags.](#)

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PERMANENT ADDRESS

Address: rfBNd3SxnhY7DR7TDnNk6m3J1JuGh8yRqr



Tag: 3617912172

UTXO-based assets

When you create an UTXO-based asset wallet, the wallet's permanent Native SegWit and Legacy addresses are automatically generated. You can also generate additional Native SegWit and Legacy deposit addresses for the wallet.

In the UTXO model, transactions are based on inputs that are almost always higher in value than the desired amount to transfer. The difference between the input and output value (the "change") is sent to the permanent address.

 Default



Bitcoin addresses

PERMANENT ADDRESS

Segwit: bc1qvrz65ax8e400hjm5g2pjf8pzfmcjtrtk9h9cje



Legacy: 19pgfUoaxkMt7aACFCzaB3ojkaWxqWtj53



The permanent address is used for whitelisting addresses on exchanges. Exchanges will send assets to the wallet's legacy permanent address when connected via the exchange API.

[Learn more](#) 

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Important: These address types are used by Bitcoin and Litecoin. Not all UTXO blockchains support the following address types.

Legacy

Legacy addresses begin with "1".

Example: `15xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`

A Legacy address is the hash output of the public key that is associated with your private key. When Bitcoin was originally launched, this was the only way to create an address. Today, Legacy-based transactions consume a lot of space in the block and consequently incur a high transaction fee.

When you withdraw funds from your connected exchange account to one of your vault accounts, Fireblocks selects the legacy permanent address as the default destination address. Some exchanges only allow withdrawals to whitelisted addresses. Therefore, for these exchanges, to perform a transaction, you must first retrieve your permanent legacy address by following these steps:

1. In the Console, copy your asset wallet's legacy address (see instructions below).
2. In your exchange portal, navigate to the whitelisted addresses or address book page and paste the legacy address from the previous step here.
3. Additional approval using a second-factor device may be required for some of the exchanges.
4. In your Fireblocks Console, initiate a withdrawal transaction from your exchange account to your vault account for this asset.

When you transfer funds from your vault to a connected exchange, Fireblocks asks the exchange to provide a legacy address. Inputs from the legacy address in the vault account are selected, and an on-chain transaction is sent.

Finding a wallet's Legacy address

To find a wallet's Legacy address in the Fireblocks Console:

1. Go to **Accounts > Vault**.
2. Open the vault account containing the appropriate asset wallet.
3. Select **See Deposit Addresses** for the asset wallet.

To find a wallet's Legacy address using the Fireblocks API, call the [Get addresses](#) endpoint and look at the legacyAddress parameter.

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Segregated Witness, also known as SegWit, was an upgrade from the Legacy address type of the Bitcoin blockchain network.

SegWit addresses begin with a 3.

Native SegWit

The Native SegWit address, also known as Bech32, is an upgrade to the original SegWit address format. It begins with a “bc1” (or “lc1” for Litecoin).

Your vault account’s permanent address is available both in the Legacy and Native SegWit formats, on both existing and new wallets.

Native SegWit is not compatible with all exchanges, but like SegWit, it has several main advantages over Legacy:

- It prevents malicious players from altering an unconfirmed transaction’s signature ID.
- Its blocks are four times larger than a Legacy block, with more transactions.
- Its transactions are processed at a faster rate and for a lower fee.
- It does not use mixed-case characters and includes an error-correction code that can detect almost all address typos.

Finding a wallet’s Native SegWit address

To find a wallet’s Native SegWit address in the Fireblocks Console:

1. Go to **Accounts > Vault**.
2. Open the vault account containing the appropriate asset wallet.
3. Select **See Deposit Addresses** for the asset wallet.

In the API, in case the Native SegWit address format is available when [creating a new Vault wallet address](#) and when [retrieving wallet addresses](#), it is then returned in the *address* field.

Address formats

Some assets have multiple address formats. Over time, some blockchain networks have added newer formats while maintaining some support for the older ones. It is important to confirm the address formats used by your counterparties. Fireblocks supports the address types below:

- **Legacy:** Bitcoin (BTC), Litecoin (LTC), Bitcoin Cash (BCH), eCash (XEC)

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- **Tezos Address:** tz1 (XTZ)
- **TON addresses:** bounceable / non-bounceable

Bitcoin and Litecoin

Bitcoin (BTC) and Litecoin (LTC) use two types of addresses: Legacy and Native SegWit. See the [Legacy, SegWit, and Native SegWit addresses](#) section for more information on these address types.

Bitcoin Cash and eCash

Legacy addresses

The Legacy address format works with Bitcoin Cash protocols (BCH and XEC), and can be converted to the more commonly used Cash Address (Cash Addr) format via web-based [conversion tools](#), or with the [create legacy address endpoint](#) in the Fireblocks API.

Cash Addresses

Cash addresses (*CashAddr*) work with Bitcoin Cash protocols (BCH and XEC). The address format is designed to help distinguish between BCH and BTC, and prevent users from sending funds to the wrong address.

Best practices

Fireblocks recommends using Cash addresses for BCH and XEC transactions whenever possible, to increase efficiency and reduce fees. However, you can use an asset's Legacy address for any transaction if necessary.

Cardano

Cardano (ADA) has multiple address types.

Base addresses

Base addresses are the most common address type and can be used for transfers and staking.

Enterprise addresses

Enterprise addresses only allow transfers. They carry no staking rights and are often used by entities that hold ADA on behalf of other users.

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Hedera (HBAR) has two address components: a no-checksum address and a five-letter checksum. Fireblocks only supports the no-checksum address component. To whitelist or transfer HBAR to a checksum address, you can safely delete the five-letter checksum and the dash that precedes it without affecting transactions.

Tezos

Tezos (XTZ) has multiple address types with different uses. Addresses can begin with tz1, tz2, tz3, kt1, or btz1. Fireblocks only generates wallets using tz1 addresses.

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info@fireblocks.com



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